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SECTOR AT A GLANCE 07

AYUSH

Health Sector in India

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The '**Sector-at-a-Glance**' provides an easy-to-read overview and basic understanding of a sector, sub-sector, or thematic area. The facts and insights on the sector are supported by relevant data and best practices from credible government and multilateral sources. The document covers the structure, key trends, opportunities and challenges, government initiatives, and the way forward for the sector.

Suggested Citation:

NITI Aayog (2023). AYUSH Sector. NITI Aayog Sector-at-a-Glance Series – Health in India, 07, <link>

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Overview



AYUSH constitutes of an assortment of traditional and unconventional healthcare and healing systems, incorporating Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa Rigpa, and Homoeopathy. These age-old systems present alternative perspectives on wellness and medical interventions, deeply rooted in historical knowledge.¹

AYUSH, an acronym for Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa Rigpa, and Homeopathy, encapsulates India's diverse traditional systems of medicine. Rooted in ancient wisdom and cultural heritage, these systems offer holistic approaches to health and well-being. The oldest system is Ayurveda, which is in existence for more than 5,000 years and Homoeopathy which is practiced in India for over 100 years.

This document, covers the origins, principles, and practices of each traditional system, highlighting their holistic approach to healthcare. The vital role played by the Ministry of AYUSH in promoting and regulating these systems within modern healthcare has also been discussed to provide readers with a comprehensive understanding of AYUSH and its integration with contemporary wellness practices.

Major Branches of AYUSH System²



Ayurveda: Ayurveda is an ancient system of medicine that focuses on balancing the body, mind, and spirit to promote health and prevent diseases using natural remedies and lifestyle practices.



Yoga and Naturopathy: Yoga is a holistic practice that combines physical postures, breathing exercises, and meditation to improve physical and mental health. Naturopathy is a system of medicine that emphasises the body's innate ability to heal itself.



Unani: Unani is based on the teachings of Greek physician Hippocrates. It uses herbal medicines, dietary adjustments, and lifestyle modifications to treat diseases and restore balance in the body.



Siddha: The Siddha system is primarily based on philosophical concepts, which encompass four main components like Iatro-chemistry, which involves the study of medicinal substances and their effects, medical practice, yogic practice and wisdom.



Sowa Rigpa: Sowa Rigpa commonly known as Amchi's medicine, is the traditional medicine of many parts of the Himalayan regions. Sowa Rigpa means Science of healing in Bodhi language.

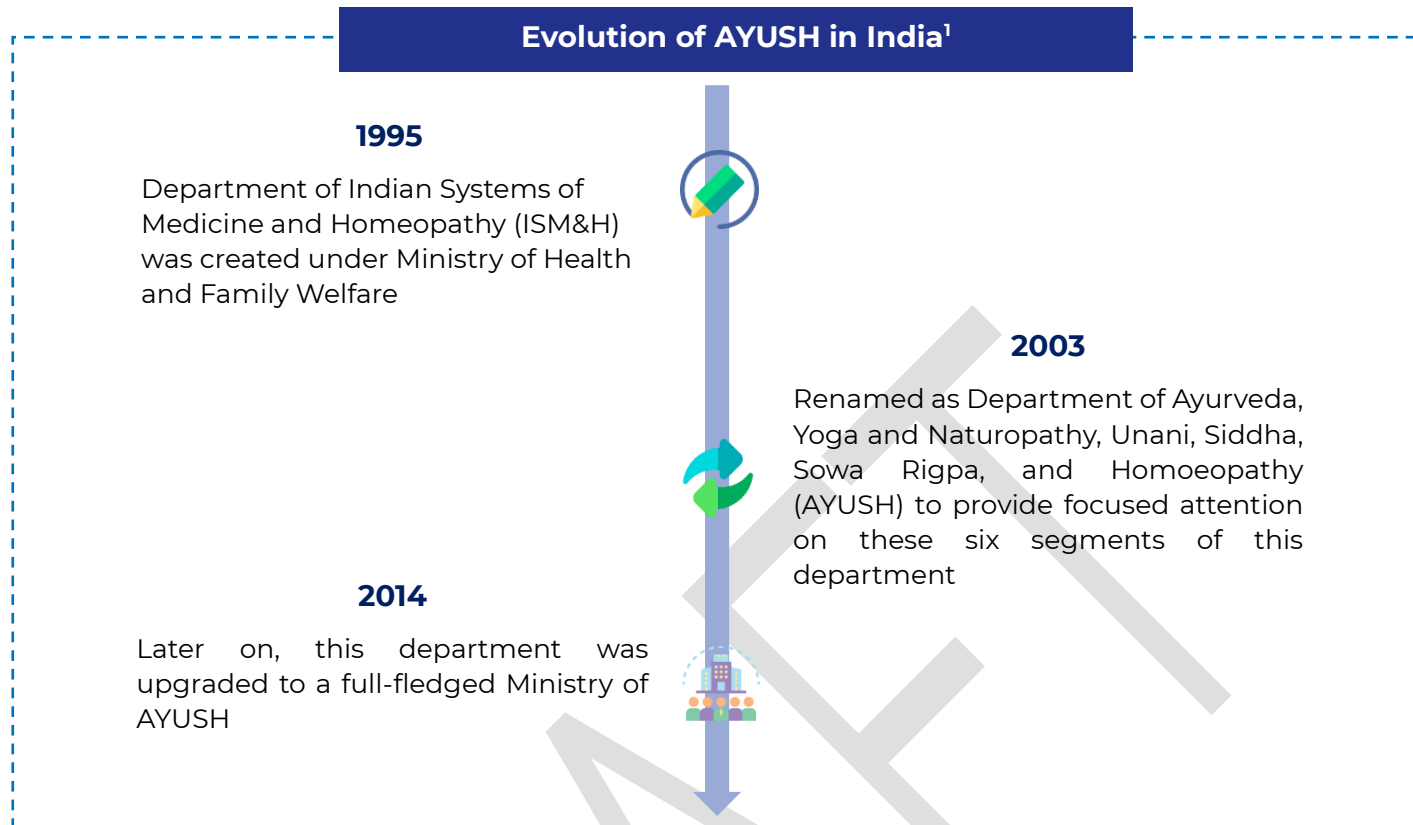


Homoeopathy: Homoeopathy is a therapeutic approach that treats diseases by using drugs that have been experimentally proven to produce similar symptoms in healthy individuals, by administering highly diluted substances.

¹ Ministry of AYUSH. (2022). *Annual Report 2022-2023*.

² Ministry of AYUSH. (2022). *National AYUSH Mission : Operational Guidelines*.

Figure 1 - Evolution of Ministry of AYUSH¹



Ministry of AYUSH: Overview¹

The AYUSH sector is currently going through a big change. The sector has experienced rapid growth in recent years, fuelled by rising local and international demand and made possible by the Ministry of AYUSH's strong support of regulatory, R&D, and backend infrastructure.



Vision

Ministry of Ayush has mandate to develop Ayush systems viz. Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa Rigpa, and Homoeopathy.

The Ministry works with the vision to position Ayush systems as the preferred systems of living and practice for attaining a healthy India. Such a vision has gradually emerged through the thought processes of experts concerned with health care provisioning in the country.



Mission

The Ministry has defined its mission through seven broad thematic areas encompassing AYUSH activities, outlined below:

- Effective Human Resource Development
- Provision of Quality AYUSH Services
- Information, Education and Communication
- Quality Research in AYUSH
- Effective Human Resource Development
- Growth of the Medicinal Plants Sector

Ministry of AYUSH: Budget

The Government of India is focusing on integrating AYUSH into the mainstream medicines and have gradually increased the budget of the Ministry to promote evidence-based research in AYUSH systems through AYUSH research councils.

Figure 2 - Ministry of AYUSH budget for 2023-24

In the year 2023-24, the total budget allocation for the Ministry of AYUSH was **INR 3,647 Crore^{1a}**

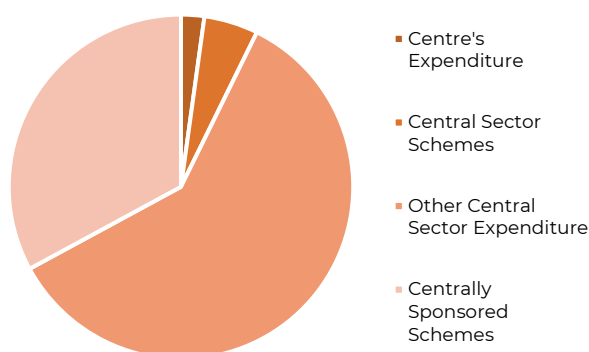
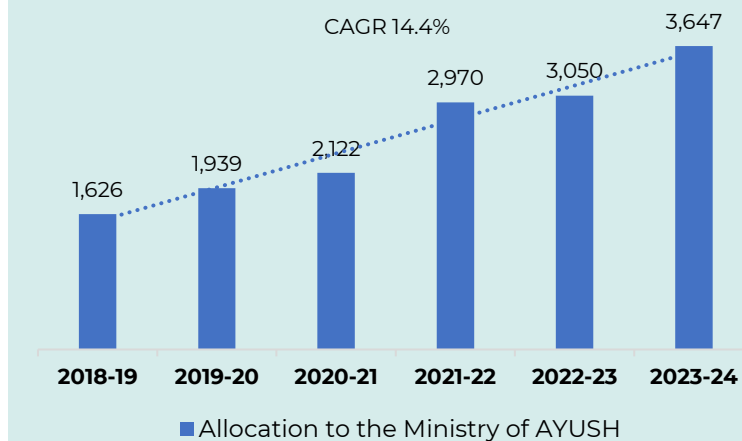


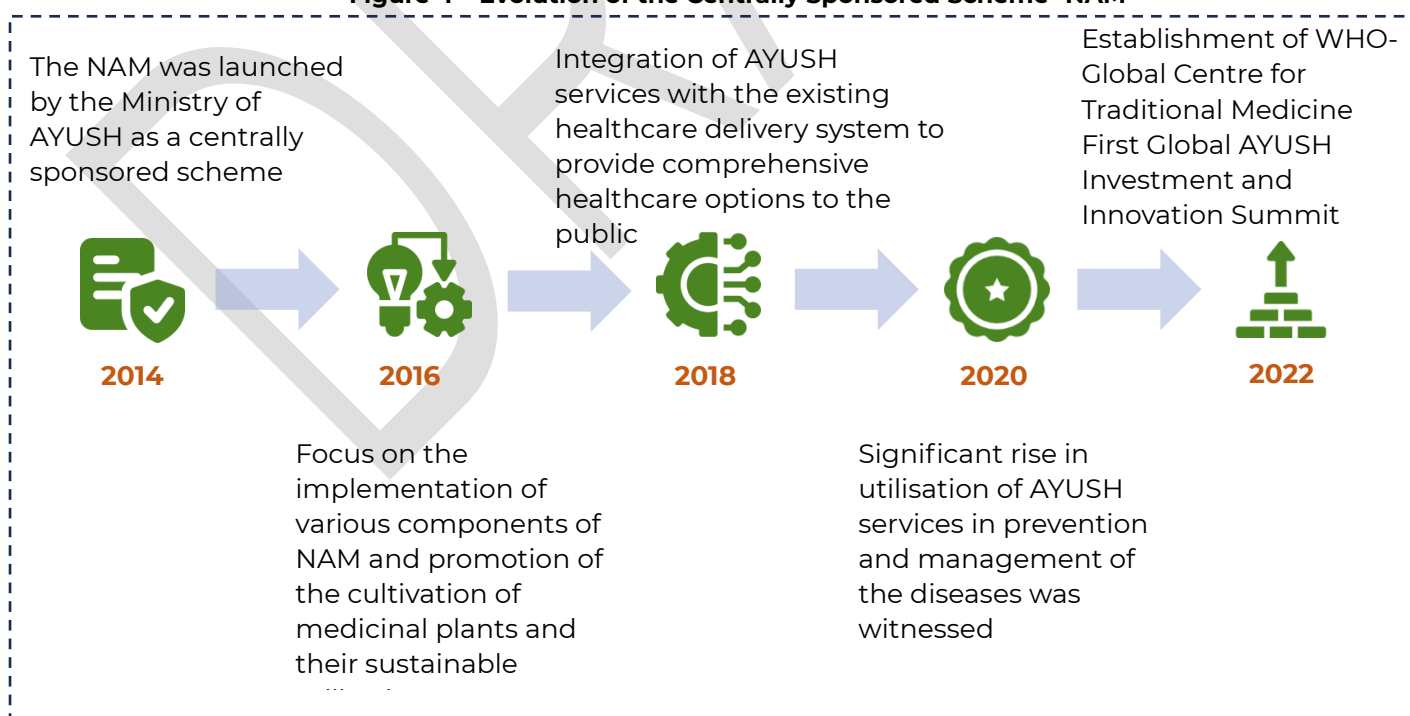
Figure 3 - Budget allocation to the Ministry of AYUSH over the years (in INR Cr)^{1b}



National AYUSH Mission¹

The **National AYUSH Mission** (NAM) launched in 2014 is the flagship **centrally sponsored mission** through which AYUSH services are provided as part of Public Health Services. The primary objective of NAM is to promote AYUSH medical systems by providing cost-effective AYUSH services, strengthening educational systems, ensuring quality control of Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, Sowa Rigpa, and Homoeopathy (ASU & H) drugs, and ensuring the sustainable availability of ASU & H raw materials.

Figure 4 – Evolution of the Centrally Sponsored Scheme- NAM¹

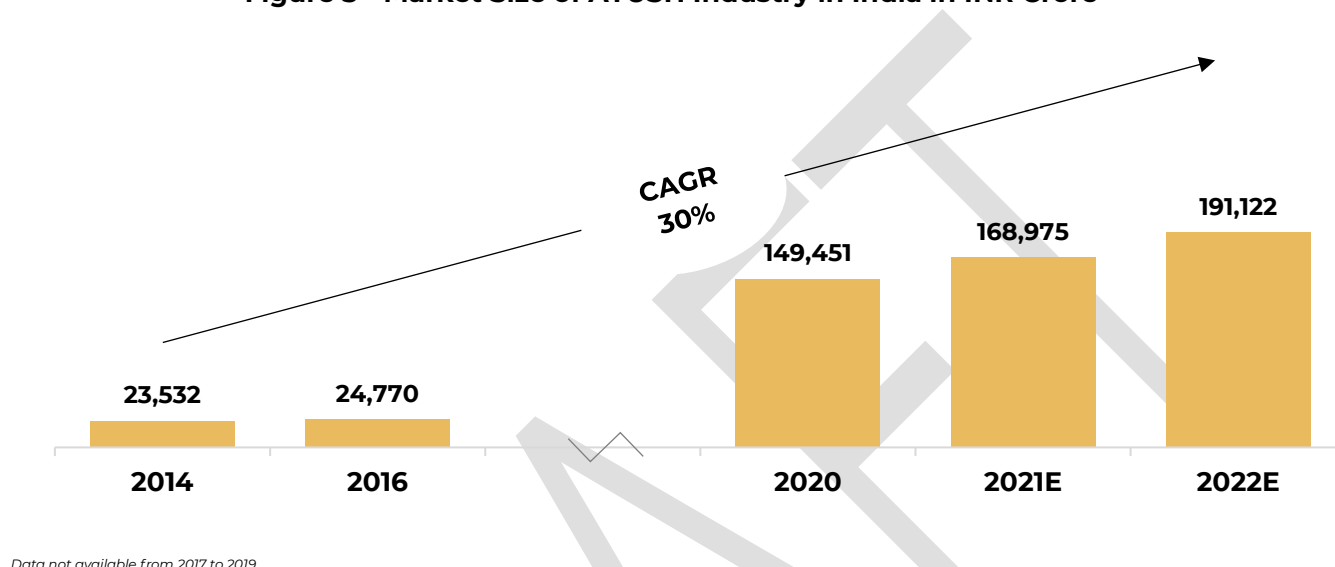


Expansion of AYUSH Practices in India⁴

Upon establishment of the comprehensive AYUSH framework, the ministry experienced a series of events in India's AYUSH journey that marked the progress and development of AYUSH practices across the nation.

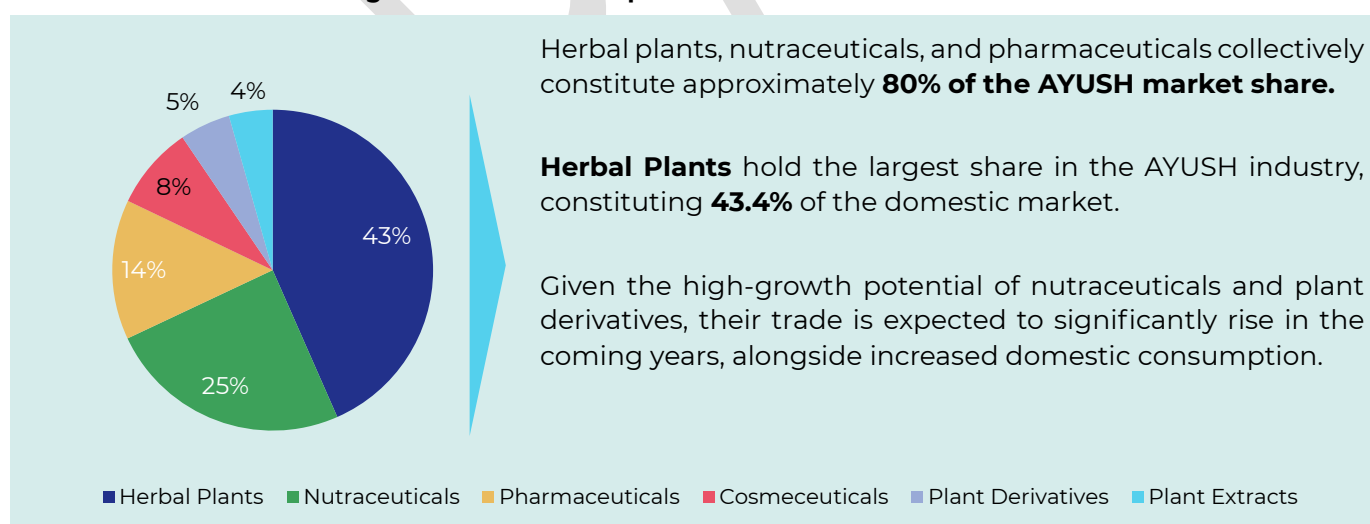
At each juncture, these events illustrated before (in page 10) have been quantified by the corresponding size of the Ayush industry in Crores, providing a tangible measure of the economic scale and importance of AYUSH within the country's healthcare landscape.

Figure 5 - Market Size of AYUSH Industry in India in INR Crore



Key Segments Market share within AYUSH⁴

Figure 6 – Various components within AYUSH sector ⁴



⁴ Research and Information System. (2021). *AYUSH Sector in India: Prospects and Challenges*.

Key Highlights of AYUSH in Domestic and International Market



Domestic Landscape

AYUSH Industry on a whole has grown nearly **eight times during 2014 to 2022**. The industry is boosted by **support from the Ministry of AYUSH** to strengthen regulatory, Research & Development and back-end infrastructure.

- ➔ Significant growth in AYUSH industry happened from **2016 to 2020** wherein the industry clocked a phenomenal **six times** growth valuing at **INR 1,49,451 Crore in 2020, from INR 24,770 Crore in 2016**
- ➔ Ease of doing business within AYUSH sector is being promoted through various government initiatives. Special incentives are provided under '**Make in India**' and '**Start Up India**'
- ➔ For instance, All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA) has collaborated with Startup India to establish "AYUSH Start-up challenge" with the aim of identifying and supporting innovations and startups in the industry



International Landscape

India has experienced significant growth in the AYUSH market compared to the global market and currently holds **~2.8% of global AYUSH** market share.

- ➔ In 2021, Ayush products worth **USD 1.26 billion** were exported from India, with a majority of 59% directed towards the USA, Europe, and UAE.
- ➔ **International Cooperation (IC) Scheme** was also developed in 2021 to promote and strengthen AYUSH at an international level.
- ➔ Ayush Export Promotion Council (AYUSHEXCIL), an Export Promotion Council (set up by Ministry of Ayush and supported by Ministry of Commerce, Government of India), was launched at Global Ayush Investment and Innovation Summit on April 20, 2022.
- ➔ Ayush Visa category is expected to boost Medical Value Travel in India and promote Indian traditional medicine globally.

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Key Trends in AYUSH Sector

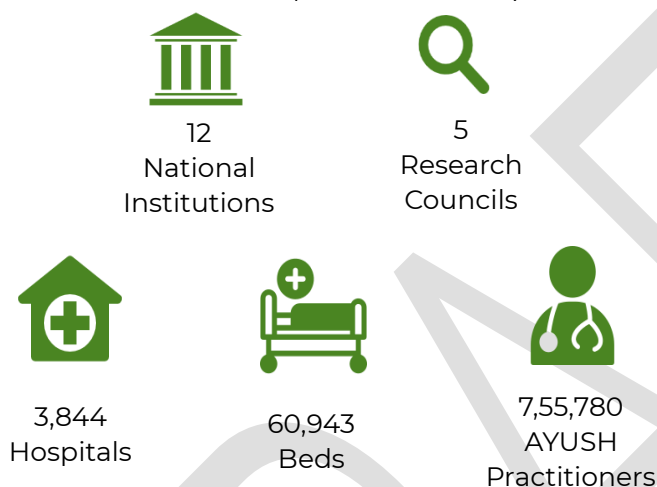
1. AYUSH Health Infrastructure¹

According to Ministry of AYUSH, it is reported that **~80-90% of Indians** prefer to use Ayurveda and other traditional systems of medicines for primary healthcare.

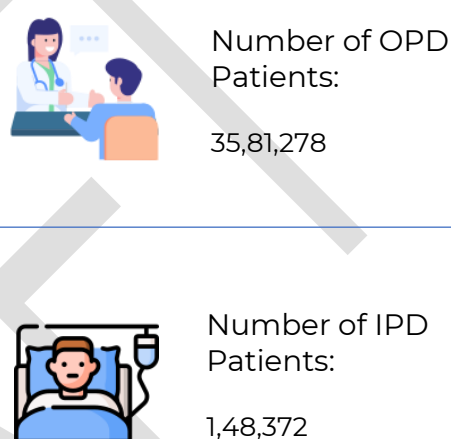
Further, through National Ayush Mission, Ministry of Ayush is working towards upgradation of 12,500 Health facilities (10,000 Ayush Dispensaries and 2500 Health sub-centres) into Ayush Health and Wellness Centre under the Ayushman Bharat.

The Ministry of AYUSH operates **12 National Institutes and five Research Councils**, all of which provide public healthcare services.

Medical Care Facilities, Medical Manpower, Institutions and Councils w.r.t to AYUSH (Data as on 2021)

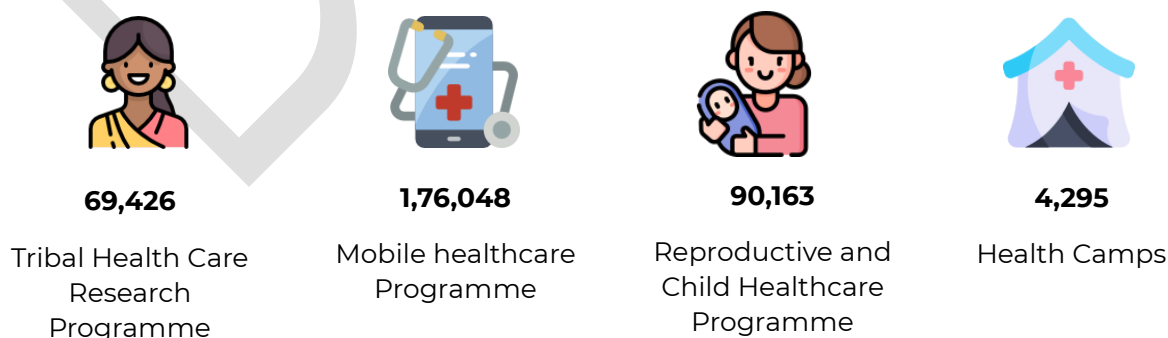


*Out Patient and In Patient Data as of 2022**



Ministry of AYUSH is implementing a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme** of the National AYUSH Mission (NAM) through the State/UT Governments and supporting their efforts to establish AYUSH treatment facilities across the nation by providing **financial support** to them under various NAM-required activities against their submitted State Annual Action Plans (SAAPs).

Numbers of Patients provided medical aid through various programme under AYUSH in 2022*

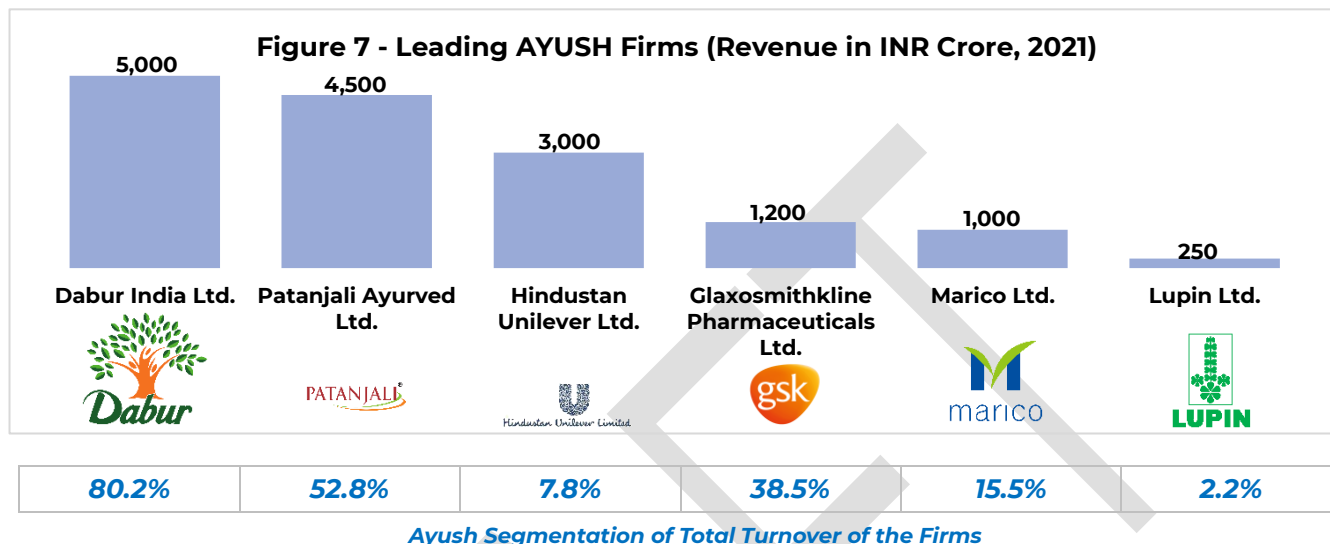


*Patient data from organizations under Ministry of Ayush (From 1st January 2022 to 31st December 2022)

¹ Ministry of Ayush. (2022). *Planning & Evaluation Division*.

2. AYUSH Industry²

There has been a strong pent-up demand for herbal, ayurvedic and related products contributing to the growth of vibrant domestic AYUSH industry. Industry has grown at a CAGR of 30% from 2014 to 2022. The rise in acceptance of AYUSH medicines and treatment has led to the growth of AYUSH Industry.



- Acceptability of AYUSH products in the Indian market have encouraged leading pharma and FMCG firms to enter the segment
- The turnover of major firms like Dabur, Patanjali, HUL, GP, Marico, Lupin accounts for INR 75,000 Crore, of which INR 15,000 Crore, **which is 20% of the total turnover**, originates from AYUSH segment.



Export

Exports for the industry increased from INR 7,043 Crore to INR 10,318 Crore during 2017-21, indicating that the firms in India are progressing in terms of product development

Top three markets where India exports are **USA (35%), EU (18.7%), and UAE (5.6%)** in 2021



FDI

The Ministry of AYUSH has tied up with Invest India to set up a Strategic Policy and Facilitation Bureau (SPFB) for promoting foreign investment into the sector.

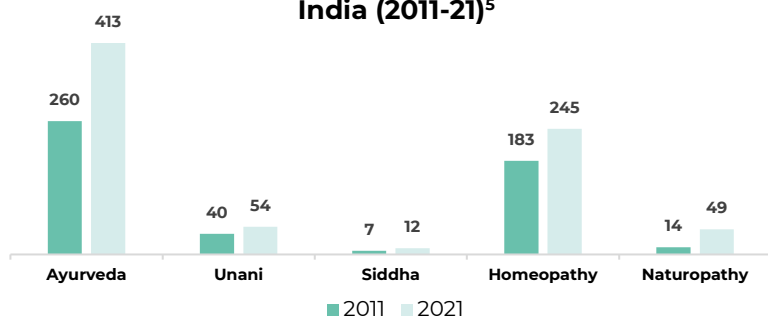
India allows **100% Foreign Direct Investment** in the AYUSH Industry.

3. Education

The National Commission for Indian System of Medicine Act of 2020 and the National Commission for Homoeopathy Act of 2020 were passed to ensure a medical education system that improves access to quality and affordable medical education, as well as the availability of adequate and high-quality medical professionals of Indian Systems of Medicine and Homoeopathy in all parts of the country.

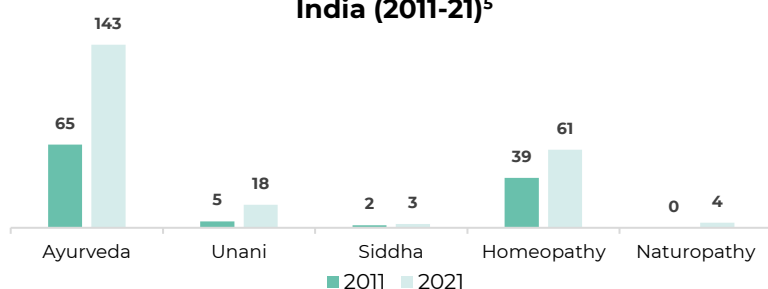
The number of AYUSH Colleges have increased significantly in the last ten years and the number of AYUSH professionals across different systems has also increased.

Figure 8a - Number of AYUSH UG colleges in India (2011-21)⁵



Undergraduate College numbers have increased across all discipline. Naturopathy college have increased from 14 to 49 in 2022.

Figure 8b - Number of AYUSH PG colleges in India (2011-21)⁵



Post graduate Colleges for Ayurveda has grown two times in a decade. While four Naturopathy colleges has been set up. There are low number of Siddha colleges too.

Percentage distribution of AYUSH registered practitioners in India as on 2021⁵



Ayurveda

50.3%



Unani

6.6%



Naturopathy

0.6%



Homeopathy

41.4%



Siddha

1.2%

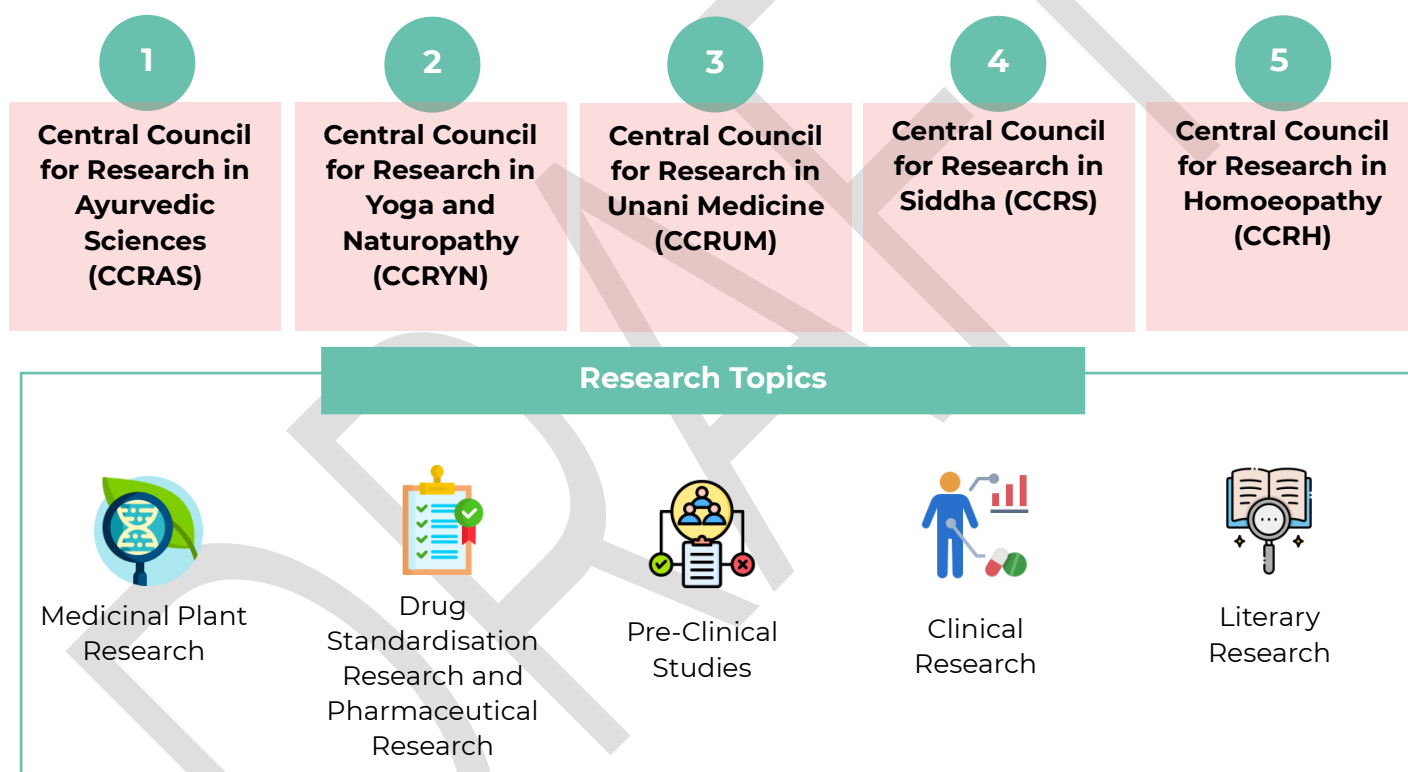
~92% of Ayush registered practitioners are of Ayurveda and Homeopathy system of medicine.

4. Research¹

Ministry has **five autonomous bodies** working under a common objective of Evidence Based Research in their respective systems of medicine for development, manufacturing and adequate supply of traditional medicines as per GOI regulatory frameworks.

In addition, the Ministry of AYUSH has conceptualised a **National AYUSH Research Consortium**, comprised of the Ministry of AYUSH, Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR), Department of Biotechnology (DBT), and Department of Science and Technology (DST), in collaboration with NITI Aayog, to build an institutionalised system of high end, world standard quality research in AYUSH systems. This consortium will use a multidisciplinary approach to own AYUSH research, sit together, visualise healthcare concerns, and plan and implement R&D activities to achieve the aim of Health for All.

These Five Research Councils are:



- At least, 90 Intramural research were completed on above research topics across five Research Councils during 2022.
- In 2022, 871 articles were published in journals of International/ National repute by organisations under Ministry of AYUSH. National Institute of Ayurveda, Jaipur had the highest number of publications in 2022 (330 articles).

5. International Partnerships and Collaboration⁷

Ministry of AYUSH under its International Cooperation (IC) scheme undertakes various activities for the promotion of AYUSH globally. Under this scheme, the Ministry of AYUSH provides support to Indian AYUSH Manufacturers/ AYUSH Service providers.

AYUSH International Collaboration as of 2022



24

MoUs for Traditional
Medicine and
Homoeopathy



43

MoUs for Collaborative
Research and Academic
collaboration



260

Students from 32
different countries
currently pursuing
AYUSH education in
India



15

Countries signed MoUs
for setting up AYUSH
Academic Chairs



39

Countries partnered for
creating AYUSH
Information Cell

As of 2022, Ministry of AYUSH is collaborating with at least **50 countries** for the promotion of AYUSH systems through country-to-country MoU, research partnerships, establishing AYUSH Hospitals, herbal garden, exchange of experts, organising workshops, conferences etc.

⁷ Ministry of Ayush. (n.d). Home. Retrieved 1 October 2023.

Opportunities and Challenges

A. Opportunities



Integrative Health

The harmonisation of modern medicine and the AYUSH system of medicine, will help mainstreaming of AYUSH and will overcome the gap between the systems and expand their reach.⁸



Research and Scientific Validation

Evolution of initiatives like MoA's agreement with the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) which aims to conduct high-quality research within AYUSH systems, will help the industry in gaining wider acceptance of Ayush practices in the domestic and global market.⁷



Global acceptance and demand⁹

MoA's International Cooperation scheme is for the promotion of AYUSH in the global markets, efforts in spreading awareness about Indian AYUSH systems, it can be utilised to increase India's share of global AYUSH market.



Capacity building¹⁰

Developing a skilled workforce can help in meeting the increasing demand for services in the AYUSH sector. Ayurgyan scheme, under the MoA, offers incentives and support to bridge any knowledge gaps and enhance the capabilities of AYUSH practitioners.



International collaborations¹

MoA boosts the exports of AYUSH products and medicines and also facilitates the international promotion, development and recognition of AYUSH systems. Some examples of the promotion are conducting workshops, setting up of AYUSH hospitals and academic institutes, research collaborations, signing MoUs, etc.

⁸ National Health Systems Resource Centre. (2009). *Mainstreaming AYUSH Revitalizing LHT under NRHM*.

⁹ Ministry of Ayush. (2022). *Central Sector Scheme for Promotion of International Co-operation in AYUSH*.

¹⁰ Ministry of Ayush. (n.d). *Ayush NGO Portal*. Retrieved 1 October 2023.

B. Challenges

At present, modern medicine therapies are employed based on empirical evidence, whereas a similar approach is not adopted for the utilisation of AYUSH systems. In May 2023, an important step was taken to promote the integration and mainstreaming of AYUSH. The ICMR and MOA signed an agreement to facilitate collaboration and cooperation in health research, particularly in Integrated Medicine.^{7,8}



Mainstreaming of AYUSH with Modern Medicine

Limited research infrastructure and investment within the industry.¹¹ There are only five Research Councils and 12 National Institutions of AYUSH in India.¹



Limited Research Centres

There is significant gap in demand and supply of raw materials^{4,1}. It is reported that the demand for high-value medicinal plants increased by 50%, while the availability declined by 26%.¹²



Raw materials related issues

The sector faces challenges in fully utilising its workforce and other infrastructure, including AYUSH hospitals and dispensaries.¹¹



Utilisation of Services

The AYUSH industry is an unorganised market which makes it difficult to regulate the quality of its products and services. There are limited Good Manufacturing Practices standards which leads to absence of quality systems.⁴



Regulatory challenges

ICMR- Indian Council of Medical Research, MOA-Ministry of AYUSH

¹¹ Lok Sabha Secretariat. (2020). *AYUSH for Healthcare*.

¹² IBEF. (n.d). *High Demand For Medicinal Plants In India*. Retrieved 1 October 2023.

Cross-Cutting Themes

Climate and Sustainability



Significance: Climate Change can affect the availability and growth of the medicinal plants. Change in temperature, precipitation patterns and habitats can influence the cultivation of medicinal plants which are used in the AYUSH systems of medicine.

Policy/Programmes: Conservation development and sustainable management of medicinal plants promotes the conservation of medicinal plants in their natural habitats, preventing degradation.

Way Forward: Research and technology development for quality assurance, building awareness about medicinal plants and promoting herbal gardens.

Education and Capacity Building



Significance: Strengthening of AYUSH workforce putting emphasis on imparting quality education to AYUSH healthcare practitioners and professionals and building their capacity to provide care

Policy/Programmes: **Ayurgyan** Scheme works towards supporting education by the way of capacity building and professional development in the sector.

Way Forward: Establishing world class AYUSH education. Upgradation of education methods by encouraging the use of technology, improving healthcare services, providing management training, advance research, and education.

Research and Development



Significance: The growing efforts of integrating AYUSH medicines into the mainstream medicinal care demand the increasing need of research and development into the subject for evidence-based results for a wider acceptance of AYUSH medicines.

Policy/Programmes: **Ayurgyan** scheme promotes Research and Innovation in AYUSH. Likewise, **Ayurwasthya** works towards upgrading of research organisations and hospitals.

Way Forward: Developing research centres and contributing towards the growth of the sector and training the young professionals.

Preventive Healthcare



Significance: AYUSH sector promotes preventive healthcare by promoting lifestyle management through yoga, dietary modifications to prevent illness and maintenance of health.

Policy/Programmes: **National AYUSH Mission** and **IEC scheme** promotes the usage of AYUSH medicines. Likewise, **Ayurwasthya** demonstrates the effectiveness of AYUSH systems in curing major diseases.

Way Forward: Promoting preventive healthcare by encouraging people to live a healthy lifestyle.

Quality and Standard



Significance: Ensuring the quality and standard of AYUSH medicines, products and treatments by following the regulatory guidelines in place ensuring safety and efficacy of the products.

Policy/Programmes: The scheme for **augmenting quality of AYUSH drugs- AOGUSY** works towards improving India's manufacturing infrastructure to provide better quality drugs for trade.

Way Forward: Strengthening the infrastructure for development of drugs by following standard regulatory frameworks and acquire standardisation certificates for the drugs for wider acceptance.

Globalisation



Significance: Strengthening the AYUSH Industry globally by promoting the products and therapies emphasising on quality control and following international standards.

Policy Programmes: **Promotion of International Cooperation** promotes AYUSH systems of medicine internationally. **Champions Services sector scheme** and Programmes like **"Heal in India"** promotes medical tourism.

Way Forward: Developing quality services and manufacturing standardised drugs for increasing exports and promoting medical tourism to increase the international footfall.

Ministry and Departments

Inter-ministerial and departmental collaboration is an important aspect of governance in India. Various ministries, departments, and organisations work together to achieve common goals and objectives.

Table 1 - Ministries and Departments working towards AYUSH sector

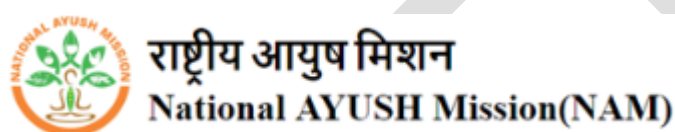
 Ministry	 Department and Bodies	 Functions and Roles
 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare	 National Commission for Indian Systems of Medicine (NCISM)	NCISM is responsible for setting standards for education, accreditation, and assessment of institutions offering education in Indian Systems of Medicine.
	 National Commission of Homoeopathy (NCH)	NCH was established to oversee and regulate the homeopathic education and practice in the country.
	 Pharmacopoeia Commission for Indian Medicine and Homoeopathy (PCIM&H)	PCIM&H acts as a Central Drug Testing cum Appellate Laboratory for Indian system of Medicine and Homoeopathy.
	 National Medicinal Plants Board (NMPB)	NMBP was established to coordinate with all matters relating to Medicinal Plants and Support Policies and Programmes for growth of trade, export, conservation and cultivation.
	 Indian Medicines Pharmaceutical Corporation Limited (IMPCL)	IMPCL is a Public Sector Undertaking under the administrative control of MoA.
	Department of Health & Family Welfare	This department plays a key role in the integration of AYUSH with the mainstream healthcare services.
		Formulation of safety and quality standards for food products under Ayurveda Aahara.

	Food Safety & Standards Authority of India	
 शिक्षा मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF EDUCATION Ministry of Education	Department of School Education and Literacy	Integration of Ayush Knowledge into the education curriculum.
 विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY Ministry of Science and Technology	Department of Science and Technology	Collaboration for research activities to validate AYUSH treatments through scientific studies and evidence-based results.
 जनजातीय कार्य मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF TRIBAL AFFAIRS Ministry of Tribal Affairs	Department of Tribal Affairs	Collaboration for tribal development through evidence-based planning, capacity building, etc.
 ग्रामीण विकास मंत्रालय भारत सरकार MINISTRY OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT GOVERNMENT OF INDIA Ministry of Rural Development	Department of Rural Development	Collaboration for the larger goal of community development and poverty alleviation in rural areas.
 वाणिज्य एवं उद्योग मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY Ministry of Commerce and Industry	Department of Commerce	Promotes the export of AYUSH products and facilitates the trade-related aspects of AYUSH.
 पर्यटन मंत्रालय Ministry of Tourism Ministry of Tourism		Promotion of wellness tourism and showcases traditional healthcare practices.

Government Interventions

1. National AYUSH Mission¹

The **National AYUSH Mission (NAM)** launched in 2014 is the flagship centrally sponsored mission through which AYUSH services are provided as part of Public Health Services. The primary objective of NAM is to promote AYUSH medical systems by providing cost-effective AYUSH services, strengthening educational systems, ensuring quality control of Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, Sowa Rigpa, and Homoeopathy (ASU & H) drugs, and ensuring the sustainable availability of ASU & H raw materials.



The Ministry of AYUSH have incorporated eight programmes under National AYUSH Mission:



National Programme for Prevention and Management of Musculoskeletal Disorders.



AYUSH Mobile Medical Units- Healthcare in underserved and far-flung areas.



Integration Of AYUSH with National Programme for Prevention and Control of Cancer, Diabetes, Cardiovascular Diseases and Stroke.



KARUNYA- To improve quality of life of patients under palliative care.



SUPRAJA- Strengthening of AYUSH based Maternal & Neo-natal Interventions through AYUSH teaching hospitals.



National Programme on AYUSH Morbidity Management and Disability Prevention (MMDP) of Lymphatic Filariasis (lymphoedema).



AYURVIDYA- Programme for promotion of healthy lifestyle in 75000 schools through AYUSH.



Setting up of different capacity hospitals.

2. Ayurgyan¹

AYURGYAN is an umbrella scheme wherein two schemes are merged to support Education, Research & Innovation in AYUSH by providing academic activities, training, capacity building etc.

The objectives of the Capacity Building and Continuing Medical Education (CME) scheme in AYUSH are to enhance capacity, promote sustainable AYUSH healthcare practices, facilitate professional development, encourage the use of technology, update knowledge, improve healthcare services, provide management training, advance research and education, address regulatory issues, and achieve interdisciplinary outcomes in priority areas.

The objectives of the Research and Innovation in AYUSH scheme include developing R&D-based AYUSH drugs, ensuring safety and quality control, establishing evidence-based efficacy, researching classical texts, assessing raw drug quality, fostering IPR potential, enhancing AYUSH human resources, and promoting collaborative research ventures with other organisations and institutes.



The components of the scheme include:

- Capacity building and Continuing Medical Education (CME) in AYUSH
- Research and Innovation in AYUSH



For 2023-24, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 9 Crore.¹³

3. Ayurwasthya¹

The Ayurwasthya scheme is a wider scheme which is a culmination of two other schemes.

The Public Health Intervention (PHI) scheme launched in 2007, demonstrates the effectiveness of AYUSH systems in addressing various public health issues. The scheme has supported 67 projects across different states, focusing on conditions like Type-II Diabetes, Hypertension, communicable diseases, and more.

Centre of Excellence scheme was initiated to meet the increasing demand and recognition of AYUSH in both domestic and global healthcare. This ongoing programme has supported 34 projects, including the development of pharmacopoeia labs, the upgrading of research organisations and hospitals, and the publication of AYUSH journals, further contributing to the sector's growth and training opportunities for young professionals.



The components of the scheme include:

- AYUSH and Public Health
- AYUSH for Sports Medicine
- Upgradation of facilities to Centre of Excellence



For 2023-24, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 6 Crore.¹³

DRAFT

4. Champions Services Sector Scheme¹

The Champion Services Sector Scheme enhances Medical Tourism in the country especially in the field of Traditional System of Medicine with the aim of establishing AYUSH Super Specialty Hospitals/ Day Care Centres. The initiative is aimed at promoting the AYUSH sector and increase the footfall of international patients/tourists in the country which will overall affect the revenue generation of the country. It also intends for developing capacity building and skill development in the sector and incentivise private investors to invest in the Ayush sector by establishing world-class super-specialty hospitals and day care centres recognised under the Indian Medicine Central Council Act, 1970, or Homeopathic Central Council Act, 1973.

The components of the scheme include:



- Establish world-class super specialty hospitals and day care centres under which facilities will be categorised into 50-bedded hospitals, 10-bedded hospitals, and day-care centres, with excellent connectivity via road, railways, air, and waterways.



For 2023-2024, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 21.68 Crore.¹³

5. Promotion of International Cooperation¹

The Promotion of International Cooperation scheme aims to achieve multi-faceted objectives, including promoting awareness and interest in AYUSH systems of medicine internationally, facilitating their promotion, development, and recognition, fostering stakeholder interaction, supporting global exchange of experts and information, promoting AYUSH products/services/education/research/training worldwide, and advancing academics and research through the establishment of AYUSH Academic Chairs in foreign countries.

The components of the scheme include:



- International exchange of experts & officers
- Incentivising drug manufacturers, entrepreneurs, AYUSH institutions, hospitals, and others to represent AYUSH internationally
- Promotion of AYUSH internationally
- Developing AYUSH information cell and healthcare institutions in foreign countries
- Providing scholarship to international students to study AYUSH medicines in India
- Strengthening export promotion council for products and services



For 2023-2024, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 44.27 Crore.¹³

¹³ Ministry of Ayush. (2023). Demand No. 4.

6. Information, Education and Communication¹

The scheme's objectives include promoting AYUSH systems through Information, Education, and Communication (IEC) activities to raise awareness about their efficacy, cost-effectiveness, and availability. It also focuses on disseminating research findings, organising events at national and state levels, fostering stakeholder interaction, and organising events like seminars and workshops to promote AYUSH systems and share recent developments in the sector.



The components of the scheme include:

- Organising AYUSH fairs at national and state levels.
- Hosting Ayurveda Parv, Yoga Fest, and similar events.
- Participating in health fairs, exhibitions, and events.
- Creating and distributing authentic publicity material across various media.
- Supporting activities related to designated "Days" of AYUSH systems and World AYUSH Festival.
- Offering financial assistance for organising AYUSH seminars, conferences, and workshops.
- Providing incentives for AYUSH industry participation in health fairs.
- Conducting webinars, virtual exhibitions, and digital events.
- Engaging in social media and new-media campaigns for AYUSH promotion.



For 2023-2024, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 41 Crore.¹³

7. AYUSH Oushadhi gunvatha evum authpadan (AOGUSY)¹

The AOGUSY scheme is for Augmenting Quality of AYUSH drugs to enhance India's manufacturing capabilities and exports of traditional medicines, improve infrastructure and technology for quality manufacturing of Ayush drugs, strengthen regulatory frameworks, and promote synergies and collaborations for maintaining standards and quality in Ayush drugs and materials.



The components of the scheme include:

- Enhancing and upgrading Ayush pharmacies and drug testing labs.
- Pharmacovigilance for ASU&H drugs, including monitoring misleading advertisements.
- Strengthening central and state regulatory frameworks and capacity building.
- Supporting standards development and accreditation/certification of Ayush products and materials through collaborations with relevant institutions and R&D centres.



For 2023-2024, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 20 Crore.¹³

8. Conservation development and Sustainable management of medicinal plants¹

The Scheme for Conservation, Development, and Sustainable Management of Medicinal Plants aims to promote in-situ conservation of medicinal plants in their natural habitats, preventing degradation, and combating invasive species, supporting ex-situ conservation in various lands and engaging Eco-Task forces to restore habitats with medicinal plant biodiversity, encouraging R&D, community mobilisation, and sustainable livelihoods related to medicinal plants, ensuring quality and modernising the supply chain, promoting standards, and implementing good practices, conducting education and communication activities, strengthening institutions, mainstreaming medicinal plants in climate change strategies, and fulfilling international obligations through cooperation.



The components of the scheme are:

- Conservation of Medical Plants
- Provide support to Joint Forest Management Committees for setting of local clusters for value addition, drying, warehousing and augmenting marketing infrastructure, etc.
- Research, Technology development and Quality assurance
- Awareness building about medicinal plants
- Promotion of herbal gardens



For 2023-24, the estimated budget for the scheme is INR 43.49 Crore.¹³

9. Other Developments



- Ayurveda Aahara is a safety & standard for food products formulated by MoA in collaboration with FSSAI.



e-aushadhi

- Digitisation of licensing and procurement of AYUSH medicines.
- 50 licensing authorities, 240 drug inspectors, and 2,000+ manufacturers registered on the portal.



- It is a National Telemedicine Service providing free consultation under MoHFW.
- E-Sanjeevani OPD have provided AYUSH practitioners a platform to reach a wider audience leading to increased patient convenience. eSanjeevani OPD has demonstrated the potential of telemedicine in driving the growth and acceptance of the AYUSH industry in India.



- It is aimed at ensuring the clinical safety of Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, and Homoeopathy (ASU & H) medicines.
- The program focuses on pharmacovigilance, which is the science and activities related to the detection, assessment, understanding, and prevention of adverse effects or any other drug-related problems.



- The “e-CHARAK” platform, which stands for e-Channel for Herbs, Aromatic, Raw material And Knowledge, is a digital platform designed to facilitate the exchange of information among various stakeholders in the medicinal plants sector.

Way Forward

A. International Priority



Recognition of AYUSH systems globally

- Growing international acknowledgment of AYUSH practices is driving the expansion of AYUSH product exports. However, at present, the export market is constrained to countries that officially acknowledge and endorse the AYUSH system of medicine.⁴
- As more countries will recognise and adopt AYUSH practices, the exports of AYUSH value-added products will rise significantly.⁴
- BIS (Bureau of Indian Standards) has established a specialised AYUSH division, releasing seven standards, with 53 more in development. They are strengthening their presence in International Organisation for Standardisation's (ISO) through the dedicated Working Group (WG 10 -Traditional Medicine) under International Organisation for Standardization's (ISO) Technical Committee (TC) (ISO/TC 215) - Health Informatics, aiming to develop International Standards for AYUSH Informatics. These initiatives are anticipated to boost the acceptance of Ayurveda products and services, facilitating extensive exports to over 165 countries.⁴
- The Ministry of AYUSH has signed MoUs for cooperation in field of Traditional medicine and homeopathy with 24 countries.¹

Boosting the reach of AYUSH⁴

- Aggressive branding and marketing of AYUSH systems.
- Campaigns connecting International Safety Measurements (ISM) with Incredible India brandings making AYUSH a common term for reliable medication.
- Government is continuously promoting AYUSH through medical tourism, for example “**Heal in India**” initiative.

B. Domestic Priority



Organised Plants market in states⁴

- A structured market in all the states to manage the availability of various medicinal plants.
- Organised mandis create a strong linkage with industry value chain establishing the much-needed traceability of products.

Linkage with other ministries⁴

- A uniform database on each sector to address the segregated information communication for stakeholders.
- The Scheme for the promotion of Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) includes the incorporation of medicinal plants, producers and institutions like the NMPB to support the growth and institutionalisation of the sector.

Strengthen state AYUSH departments⁴

- Active involvement of states in the regulation, management and administration of products and services, facilitating the overall growth and strengthening of the AYUSH Industry.

Enforcement of Recognised Standards⁴

- WHO GMP-Good Manufacturing Practices Guidelines being upgraded for mandatory standards compliance.
- MoA in collaboration with Bureau of Indian standards will develop international standards for AYUSH products as well as services.

One Nation, One Health¹

- It involves the integration of the strengths of AYUSH, which focuses on health maintenance, promotion, and disease prevention, with modern medical systems that utilise biologics like vaccines for disease prevention and provide effective management for acute and life-threatening conditions. This integration aims to overcome the gap between traditional and modern healthcare approaches, ensuring that integrated healthcare is accessible to all.
- The mainstreaming of AYUSH in healthcare is significant as it can offer a more holistic approach to patient care, combining the strengths of both conventional medicine and AYUSH system of healthcare.¹¹

1. Distribution of AYUSH prophylactic medicines amongst community in Goa¹⁴



Background

State of Goa, engaged in procurement and distribution of Ayurvedic and Homoeopathic prophylactic medicines to the public as measure against building COVID-19. Doctors were assigned various roles, and post-Covid AYUSH clinics were swiftly established to aid patients in recovery. Regular OPDs also provided counselling to alleviate mental stress. Collaborative efforts allowed tele-consultation services for home-quarantined individuals, and AYUSH doctors were contractually appointed to assist in Covid-related duties across facilities.



Steps taken by the government

- Ayurvedic and Homoeopathic prophylactic medicines, including Chyavanprash, Sanshamani Vati, and Arsenicum album-30, were procured and distributed to government offices, NGOs, and the public through various channels.
- AYUSH medicines were provided to COVID Care Centres (CCCs), shelter homes, and home-quarantined patients.
- Post-COVID-19 AYUSH clinics were established at AYUSH Dispensaries co-located in healthcare facilities across the state.
- A common post-COVID-19 AYUSH management protocol, following MoA guidelines, was implemented, offering dietary, lifestyle, and yoga recommendations.
- Public advisories and self-care guidelines from the MoA were circulated and followed.
- Ayurveda and Homoeopathic leaflets were printed in multiple languages and distributed to households for awareness on immunity-boosting measures.
- Preventive healthcare and lifestyle emphasis were integrated into annual calendar programmes and events like Ayurveda Day and International Day of Yoga.
- The AYU-SAMVAD campaign conducted regular awareness activities, including camps, talks, competitions, workshops, and yoga sessions.
- Timely supply of Ayurvedic and Homoeopathic prophylactic medicines was ensured through state agencies like Goa Antibiotics Pharmaceutical Ltd., HLL Life Care Ltd., and The Punjab Homeo Pharmacy.



Impact generated

Reallocation of NAM funds were carried out to expedite the purchase of Ayurvedic and Homoeopathic prophylactic medicines.

Figure 9- Distribution of AYUSH medicines



¹⁴ NITI Aayog. (2023). *Mitigation and Management of COVID-19. Compendium of AYUSH Based Practices.*

2. Provision of prophylactic and therapeutic treatment, Gujarat¹⁴



Background

AYUSH in Gujarat has actively contributed by utilising human resources and infrastructure, conducting research, and promoting COVID-19-appropriate behaviour and AYUSH preventive and therapeutic measures. AYUSH, Gujarat, has been an integral part of the state's Health Department COVID-19 response team. The public has widely accepted AYUSH prophylactic measures. The state's initiatives aim to provide excellent health through AYUSH interventions during the pandemic and integrate AYUSH protocols with conventional medical guidelines for patient well-being.



Steps taken by the government

Prophylactic Intervention: The distribution of preventive medicines in the state began on March 6, 2020, during the first wave of the pandemic, and this continued until at least October 12, 2021 and was done through cumulative efforts of AYUSH doctors, NGOs, volunteers and field-level social leaders.

- Therapeutic Intervention: AYUSH was integrated into the mainstream healthcare system in Gujarat, with the state pioneering the inclusion of AYUSH treatments for mild to moderate COVID-19 cases in Designated COVID Hospitals (DCHs). From April 24, 2020, to June 30, 2021, a total of 25,965 beneficiaries received Ayurveda interventions, and 7,164 received Homoeopathy interventions through 21 DCHCs and DCHs. Additionally, 16,330 patients were treated with Ayurvedic and/or Homoeopathic medicines at COVID Care Centres (CCCs).
- Other Initiatives
 - Guidelines published by Ministry of AYUSH translated in local language.
 - Awareness of potential of AYUSH intervention to improve immunity and curing health problems.



Impact generated

Patients diagnosed with COVID-19 were primarily treated within the allopathic healthcare system, with AYUSH interventions allowed only as supplementary therapy. This limited the ability to fully explore the potential of various AYUSH streams in treating COVID-19 patients. Additionally, deploying AYUSH healthcare personnel in COVID dedicated centres had an impact on the delivery of AYUSH healthcare services in some locations.

Figure 10: AYUSH Prophylactic and Therapeutic intervention in Gujarat



3. Supply of Medicines, Tamil Nadu¹⁴



Background

The state effectively utilised AYUSH traditional knowledge to manage COVID-19, with AYUSH practitioners following government and regulatory guidelines. During the pandemic, thousands of COVID-positive patients received treatment in AYUSH COVID Care Centres (CCCs). Kabasura Kudineer was widely distributed across containment zones and healthcare settings. An exclusive Siddha Covid war-room was established in Chennai during the second wave. Various AYUSH initiatives included prophylaxis, self-care, exclusive Siddha treatment for mild COVID cases, and post-Covid care for fever and convalescent individuals.



Steps taken by the government

- The Government of Tamil Nadu launched the Aarogyam Special Scheme for AYUSH interventions during COVID-19, featuring Kabasura Kudineer (KSK) as a preventive concoction.
- KSK was produced in AMMA UNAVAGAM and distributed widely, benefiting millions in Chennai and other areas.
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) were established for Siddha COVID Care Centres (CCCs) across the state.
- During both waves of the pandemic, a significant number of COVID-positive patients received treatment in AYUSH CCCs, including Siddha CCCs.
- Post-Covid Siddha OPDs were established.
- Public awareness campaigns promoted homemade remedies, herbal hand wash, herbal tea, and healthy dietary modifications.



Impact generated

The State ensured the provision of medicines such as Kabasura Kudineer, natural immunity boosters, oils, and equipment like steam inhalers to all Siddha CCCs.

Figure 11: Supply of Medicines during COVID-19 in Tamil Nadu



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